aws FOR SOFTWARE AND TECHNOLOGY

Design and Messaging Playbook

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Introduction

This document provides AWS marketers and agencies with a playbook for building campaigns and communications related to our Independent Software Vendor (ISV) customers. The ISV segment is broad—from large established enterprises to small and agile startups.

When speaking to or about this audience, we fly under the banner of “AWS for Software and Technology,” with a logo lockup specially made for this purpose. From a brand architecture standpoint, AWS for Software and Technology is a “brand investment” — a priority investment that reflects AWS’ strategic vertical focus while delivering on Tentpole purpose — providing AWS with credibility and permission to stake claims in this specific space. While AWS for Software and Technology has unique visual and verbal guidance aimed at reaching this specialized audience, we are first and foremost AWS.

Consider this guidance as an addendum to the overall AWS identity system guidance when creating materials for this key audience.

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SECTION 01

Messaging

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Messaging

Overview

Thinking about ISVs as customers

Even though many Independent Software Companies end up as AWS technology partners, it is important to remember that the first engagement any ISV has with AWS is as a customer. These companies may be at any point in their cloud-adoption journey, from pre-adoption (off cloud/on premises), to new-to-cloud, or even very sophisticated “born in the cloud” consumers of cloud services. Marketing can play a key role in supporting them on this path.

ADDITIONAL GUIDANCE:

This guide touches on audience segmentation and messaging and is intended to complement the more robust All-up ISV Messaging Guide.

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Messaging

Value proposition

Celebrating our promise to ISVs: freedom

Software keeps changing the world. And software companies are changing, too. They're working in new ways, exploring new technologies, and developing a huge breadth of specialized offerings, for multiple markets. Increasingly, they do all of this via the cloud. And they want a cloud provider that offers them freedom to create and grow — on their terms. At AWS, we believe in giving software companies exactly that. We combine technical expertise and strategic business advice with an obsession for customer success.

Which means listening, collaborating, and adapting to their goals. Never limiting their options or pursuing a pre-set agenda. Always encouraging new ideas, new solutions, and new business models. Our promise to software companies is simple:

AWS will give you the freedom to do more. Freedom to modernize. Freedom to innovate. Freedom to scale.

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Messaging

Audiences

We are focused on four key audiences, each with nuanced needs, and messaging should be adjusted accordingly. Below is some sample messaging to give you a sense for how each audience should be addressed.

Chief Product Officers and Product Managers

Software companies are striving for product-led growth. Which means modernizing your business model, while controlling costs to ensure profitability.

Chief Product Officers play an essential role in striking this balance. Your roadmap must bring new cloud-based products and features to market quickly to generate revenue. But you also need a strategy for reinvesting these to migrate and modernize more of your portfolio.

Amazon Web Services (AWS) can help guide you on this journey. We echo your passion for transformation. We understand the pressures involved in managing a complex product roadmap, and we'll give you the transparency and control you need to succeed.

Chief Revenue Officers and Business Development / Alliance Managers

Software companies are striving to modernize their business model, so they can bring new products to market ahead of the competition, acquire new customers, and enter new and adjacent markets.

As a Chief Revenue Officer, you are responsible for responding to new customer demands and translating new opportunities into commercial returns.

Amazon Web Services (AWS) can proactively support you to drive this revenue growth. Building on our own experience, we'll help you enrich your product lifecycle and monetize new upgrades and features—while simplifying pricing to give you and your customers greater visibility and control over costs.

AWS can help you succeed in delivering more revenue to the top line, as you modernize your software business in the cloud.

Chief Technology Officers

Software companies are seeking a competitive edge by modernizing their business model and embracing the best in new technology.

As a Chief Technology Officer, you are responsible for identifying the cloud tools that will drive innovation at the right price, while maximizing the value of your existing investments.

Amazon Web Services (AWS) gives you the choice and control you need. Together, we can assess your current strategy and infrastructure stack, and identify opportunities for improvement.

Building on our own experience as a software company, we'll provide the agile and secure building blocks you need to achieve SaaS success — at speed and scale. We'll also provide expert guidance and technical resources for your teams, so you can attract and retain the best development talent.

AWS can help you to modernize your business using best-in-class cloud technologies for a competitive edge.

Engineering Leads and Solutions Architects

Software companies are seeking a competitive edge by modernizing their business model and launching the most innovative products to market.

Your engineering and solution teams therefore require the very best tools and capabilities to build your product roadmap, with speed and efficiency.

Amazon Web Services (AWS) is architected to provide the open, flexible, and secure environment they need. Leveraging our own development experience, we offer a building block approach to SaaS that's underpinned by expert technical support and guidance.

AWS can help modernize your business by giving your teams the tools to build best-in-class cloud products and solutions.

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Messaging

Audience-specific executions (ex. social graphics)

Chief Product Officers / Product Managers

Chief Revenue Officers / Business Development

Chief Technology Officers

Engineering Leads / Solutions Architects

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Messaging

Common terminology

Some common terms you'll want to understand when operating in the ISV category:

SaaS

Software as a Service (SaaS) is traditionally considered a cloud-based software model that delivers applications to end-users through an internet browser. SaaS vendors host services and applications for customers to access on-demand. One typical aspect of a SaaS model is pricing that's paid on a subscription or pay-as-you-use model, instead of purchasing all functionality at once in one big chunk. A common example of a SaaS application is a third-party web-based email application, where users can send and receive emails without having to manage feature additions to the email product or maintain the servers and operating systems that the email program is running on.

Learn more

iPaaS (or PaaS)

Integration platform as a service (iPaaS) — sometimes referred to as Platform as a Service PaaS — is a cloud-based software model for integrating data from multiple applications into a single solution. Most organizations today have multiple applications that handle various aspects of their business processes and IT operations. They must integrate data from all their applications for analytics and deeper business intelligence. With iPaaS, nontechnical users can easily integrate data from third-party software as a service (SaaS) applications and on-premises data centers into a centralized cloud-based service. The iPaaS solution abstracts underlying data integration complexities. This means nontechnical users meet integration needs without requiring complex software development or additional middleware technologies.

Learn more

Iaas

Infrastructure as a Service (IaaS) is a business model that delivers IT infrastructure like compute, storage, and network resources on a pay-as-you-go basis over the internet. Businesses can use IaaS to request and configure the resources they require to run their applications and IT systems. The company is responsible for deploying, maintaining, and supporting the applications, and the IaaS provider is responsible for maintaining the physical infrastructure. Infrastructure as a Service gives software and technology companies flexibility and control over their IT resources in a cost-effective manner.

Learn more

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SECTION 02

Visual System

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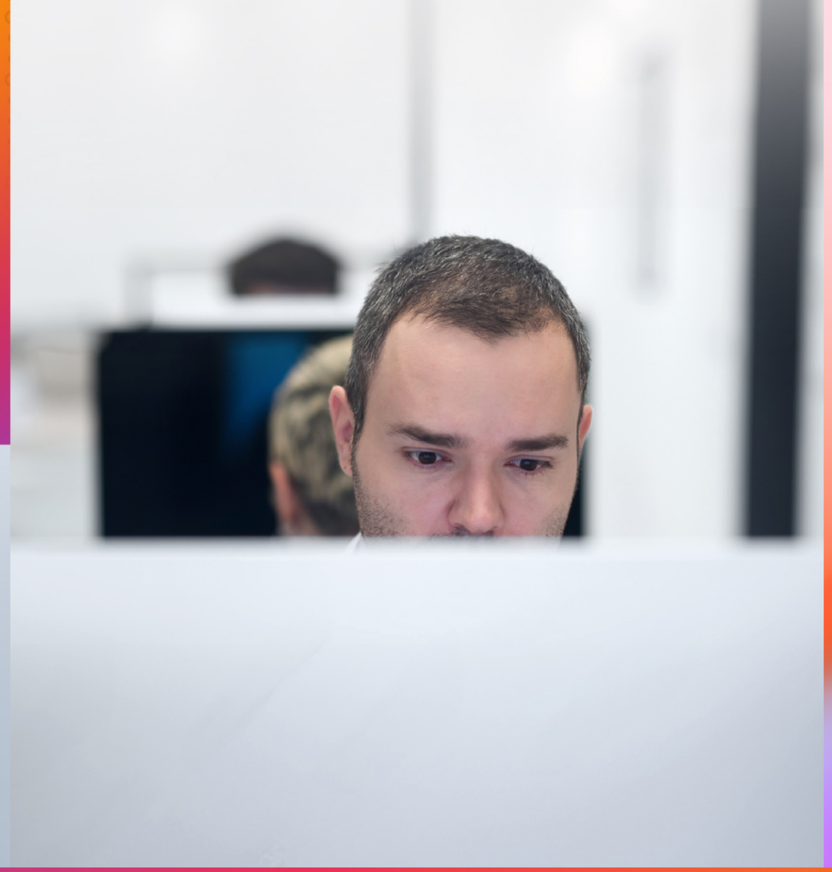
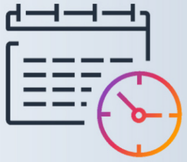
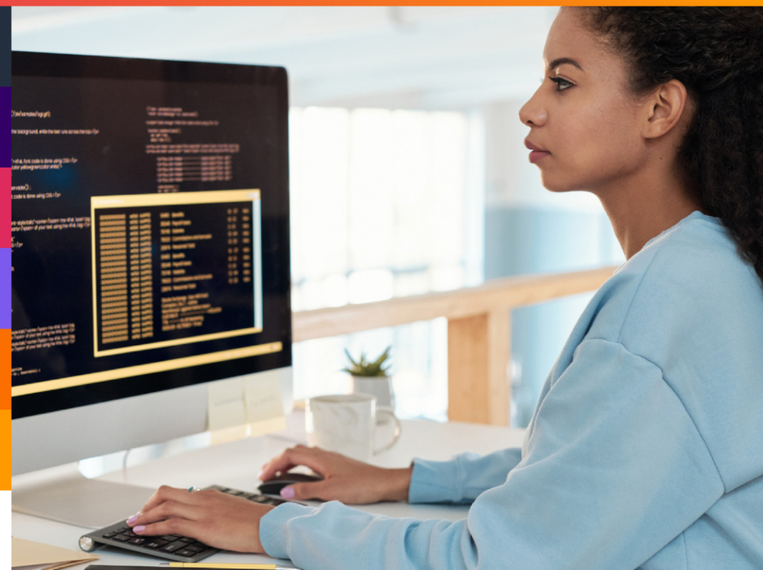
Visual System

Overview



Freedom
to scale





Visual System

Logo options

Two Logo Options

For ISV materials, you can either use the Brand Investment logo Lockup (available in Squid Ink or White) or you can use the standard AWS (tentpole) logo. When using the tentpole logo, be sure to find a prominent and consistent place in the layout for the words “For Software Companies.”

Option 1 Brand Investment Logo Lockup

aws FOR SOFTWARE AND TECHNOLOGY

Clear space

Pictured here is the minimum measure of clear space that is required. The clear space scales in proportion to the size of the logo, so if the logo gets bigger, the clear space measure should increase as well.

Minimum size

The logo width must be at least 1.5 inches for print, 155 px for a 1x resolution screen, or 332 px for a 2x resolution screen.

Option 2 Tentpole Logo + Mention in Text

(Sample Layout)

Follow clear space and minimum size guidance for tentpole brand.

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Visual System

Color

Use of Color

Like many brand expressions of AWS, the visual system for the ISV communications uses colorful gradients drawn from the overall brand palette.

Specifically, the ISV system uses predominantly light, neutral backgrounds, with smaller accents of vibrant color. As a result, most of our designs use dark (Squid Ink) text and logos.

Color Swatches

Squid Ink	Galaxy	Cosmos	Violet	Smile/Amber 400	Amber 500	Amber 600
#232F3E RGB (35, 47, 62)	#330066 RGB (51, 0, 102)	#DF2A5D RGB (223, 42,93)	#7C5AED RGB (124, 90, 237)	#FF9900 RGB (255, 153, 0)	#FA6F00 RGB (250, 111, 0)	#D14600 RGB (209, 70, 0)

Neutrals (in addition to Squid Ink)

White	Gray 50	Gray 100	Gray 200	Gray 300	Gray 400	Gray 500	Gray 600
#FFFFFF RGB (255, 255, 255)	#F6F7F9 RGB (246, 247, 249)	#EFF2F6 RGB (239, 242, 246)	#E2E8EE RGB (226, 232, 238)	#C6D0DC RGB (198, 208, 220)	#B3BFCD RGB (179, 191, 205)	#79889A RGB (121, 136, 154)	#586779 RGB (88, 103, 121)

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Visual System

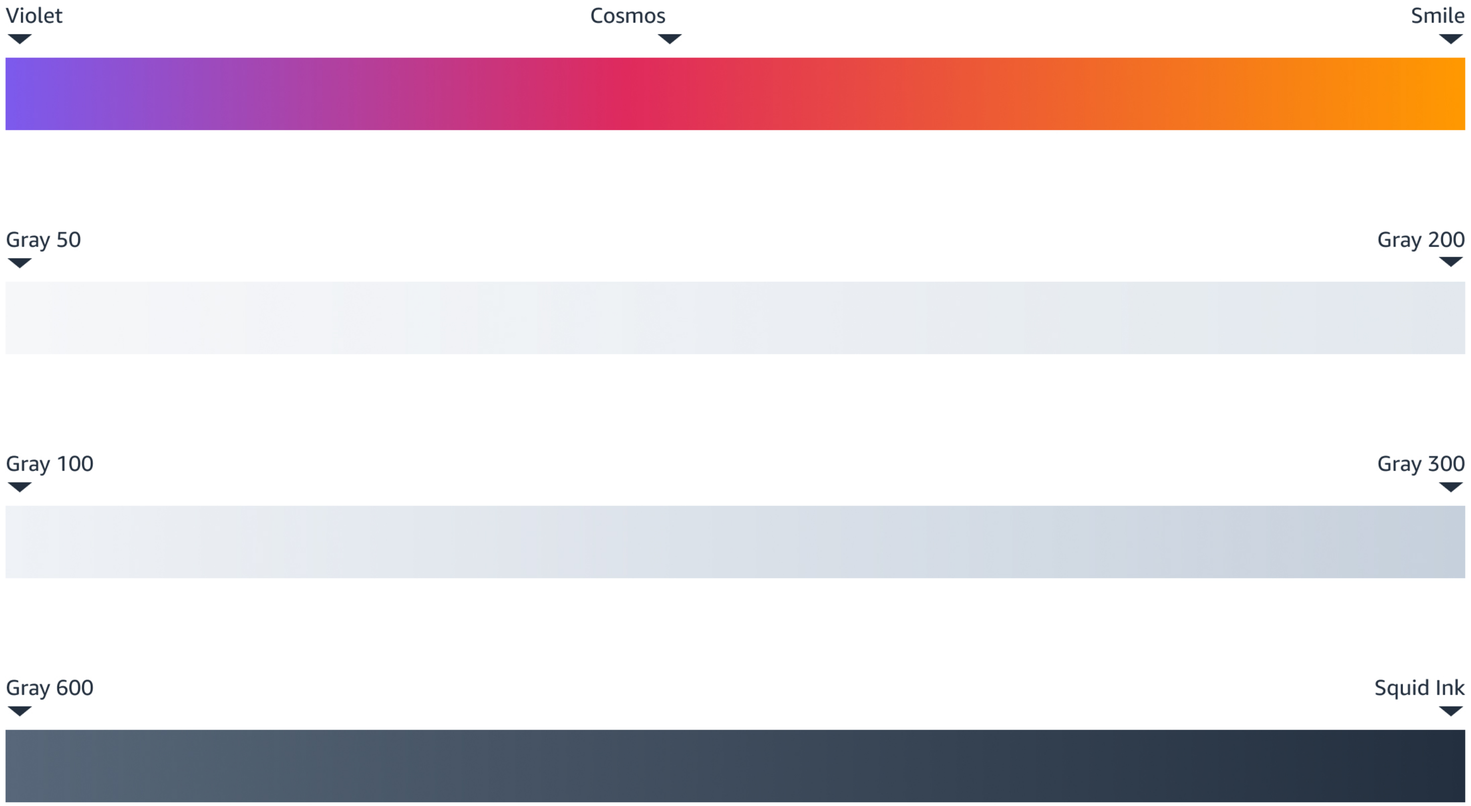
Gradients

Since ISV materials emphasize light and airy layouts, the most common backgrounds are either white, or else gradients made using the lighter shades within the neutral palette.

Generally, use small accents of the more vibrant colors of the palette, including the Violet > Cosmos > Smile linear gradient, or the light gradient mesh.

For occasional impact and contrast, use dark neutral backgrounds like the Gray 600 > Squid Ink linear gradient, or the rich gradient mesh.

Linear Gradients



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Visual System

Backgrounds

The five backgrounds shown on this page are available as images that can be placed into ISV communications materials. They can be rotated, mirrored or cropped as needed to allow for different layout needs.

1

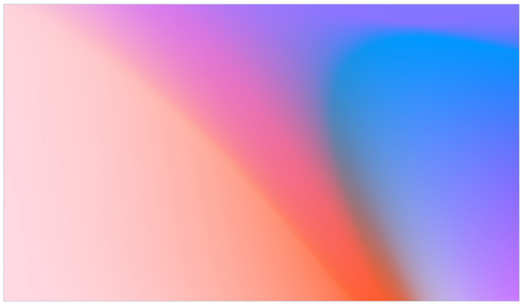
2

3

4

5

5



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Visual System

Color overlay

Use the transparent color overlay over photos to introduce the ISV color palette to an otherwise neutral photo, or to provide a clean background for typography. You can use the entire overlay image, or crop it partially to see only part of the color palette.

Transparent color overlay

Placed over an image

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Visual System

Photography

Lifestyle photography helps us connect the technology we build to the lives we hope to positively impact. All our lifestyle photos should feel natural and relatable. Lighting, props, and settings should feel realistic. When choosing which photos to use, be inclusive. Respectfully represent all our customers, employees, and business partners to help address under-representation and tokenism in advertising and marketing. Consider context and impact, avoiding appropriation and stereotypes. Be mindful of the many spectrums of identities and remember representation is intersectional.

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Visual System

Campaign images

The three abstract images shown here are available for use to represent these specific ideas related to the ISV audience:

- Migrate and Modernize
- Innovate with SaaS
- Scale and Grow

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Visual System

Portraits

For testimonials, case studies and other instances where real people are depicted, crop portraits into circles, showing the person's head and a small amount of their shoulders. When showing multiple portraits, make sure to size people equivalently within the cropping shapes.

Andy Jassy

President and CEO, Amazon

First Lastname

Job Title, Company or Organization

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Visual System

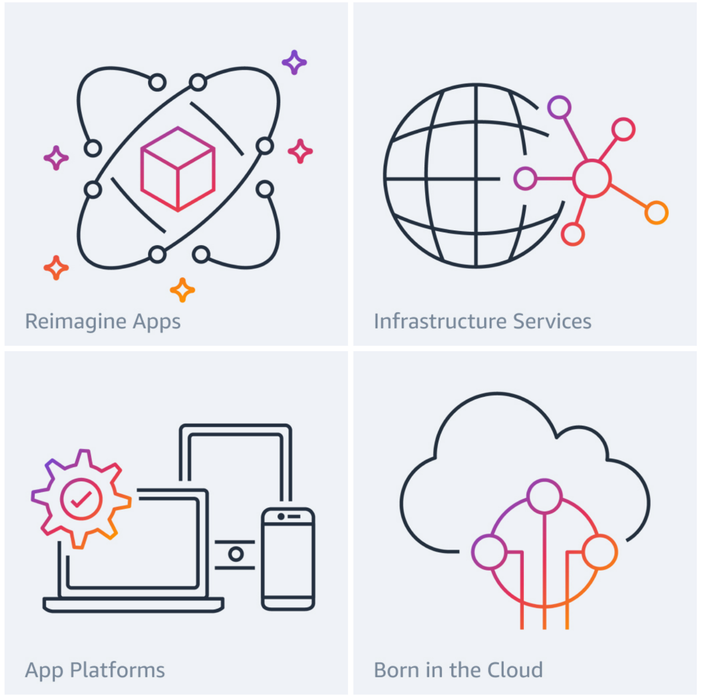
Marketing illustrations

An initial set of marketing illustrations is available for use in ISV communications. These are built in the style of AWS brand illustrations, and have been modified to use the ISV color palette. They are available in positive and reverse color ways.

Use these elements sparingly, when you are not able to source photography that meets the creative bar, when photography can’t work due to production limitations, or when other graphic elements don't meet your marketing needs.

These assets should only be used in brand marketing materials (ex. eBooks, PowerPoint decks, social/digital advertising, etc.). They should NOT be used on the marketing website due to different accessibility standards.

Positive



Reverse

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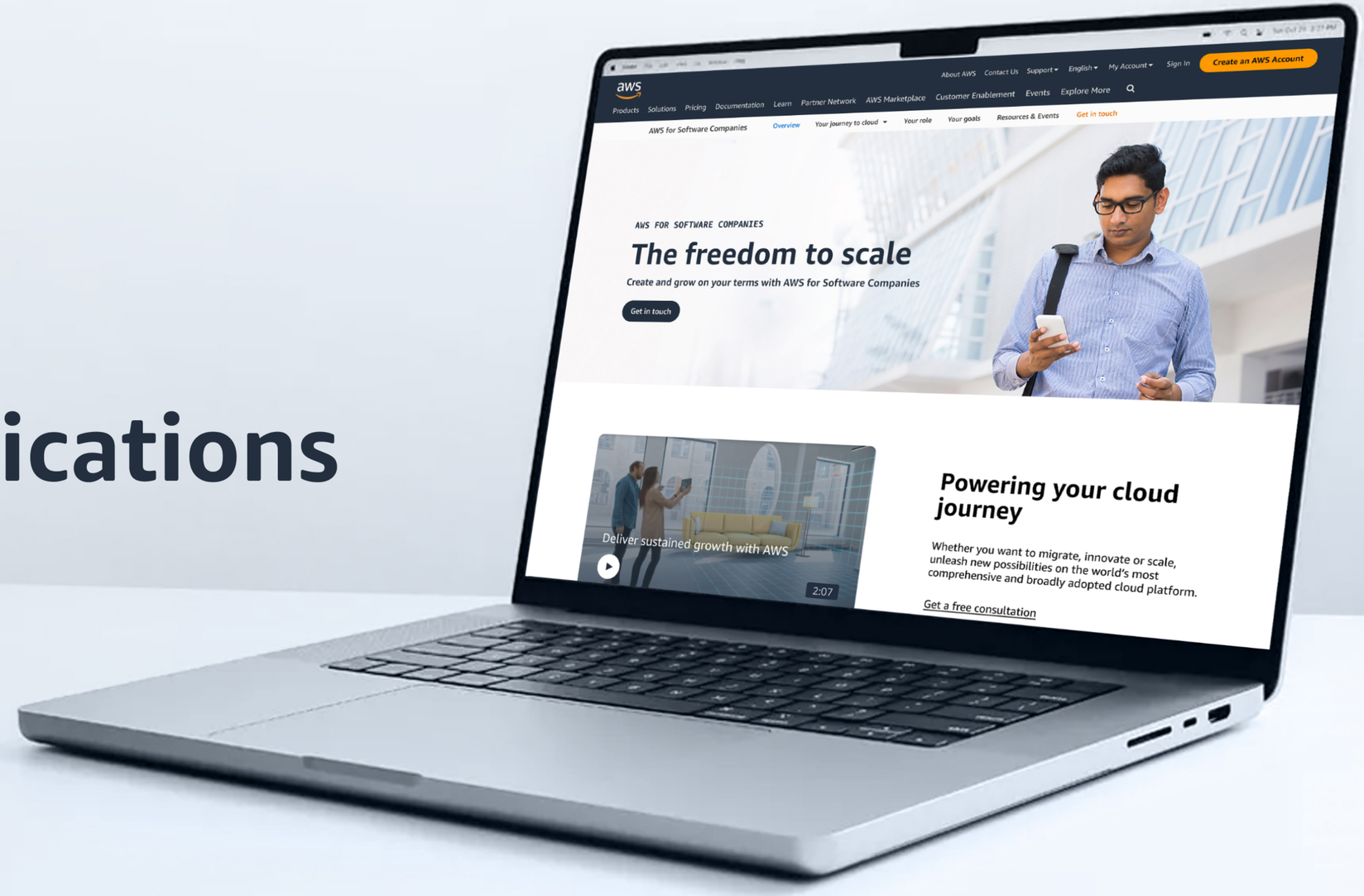
SECTION 03

Sample Applications



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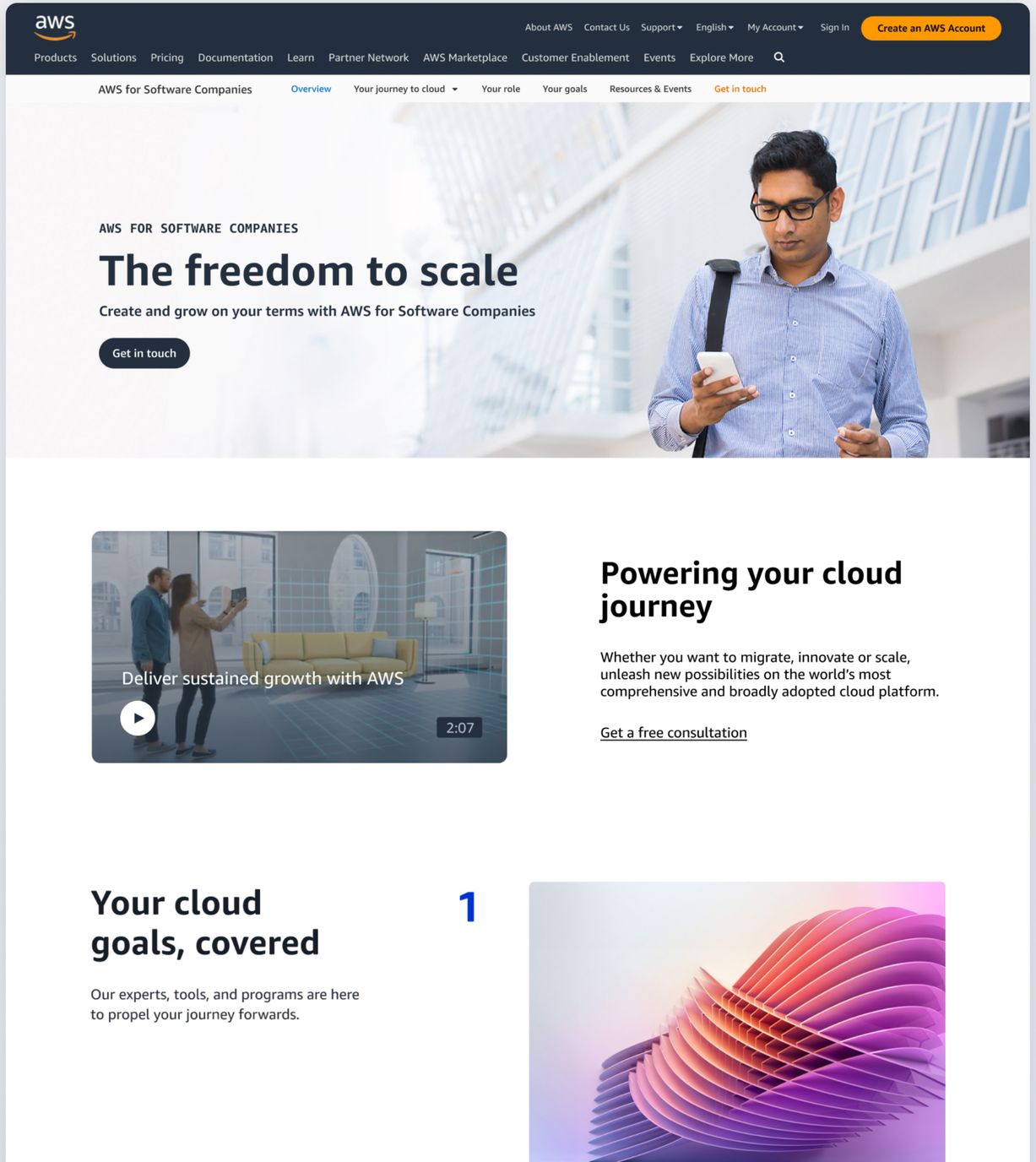
Web landing page



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Why migrate apps to the AWS cloud?

A platform that maximizes agility, flexibility, security and scalability for your business

Amazon confidential

e AWS Cloud to:

ation
l Innovation
echnologies,
features

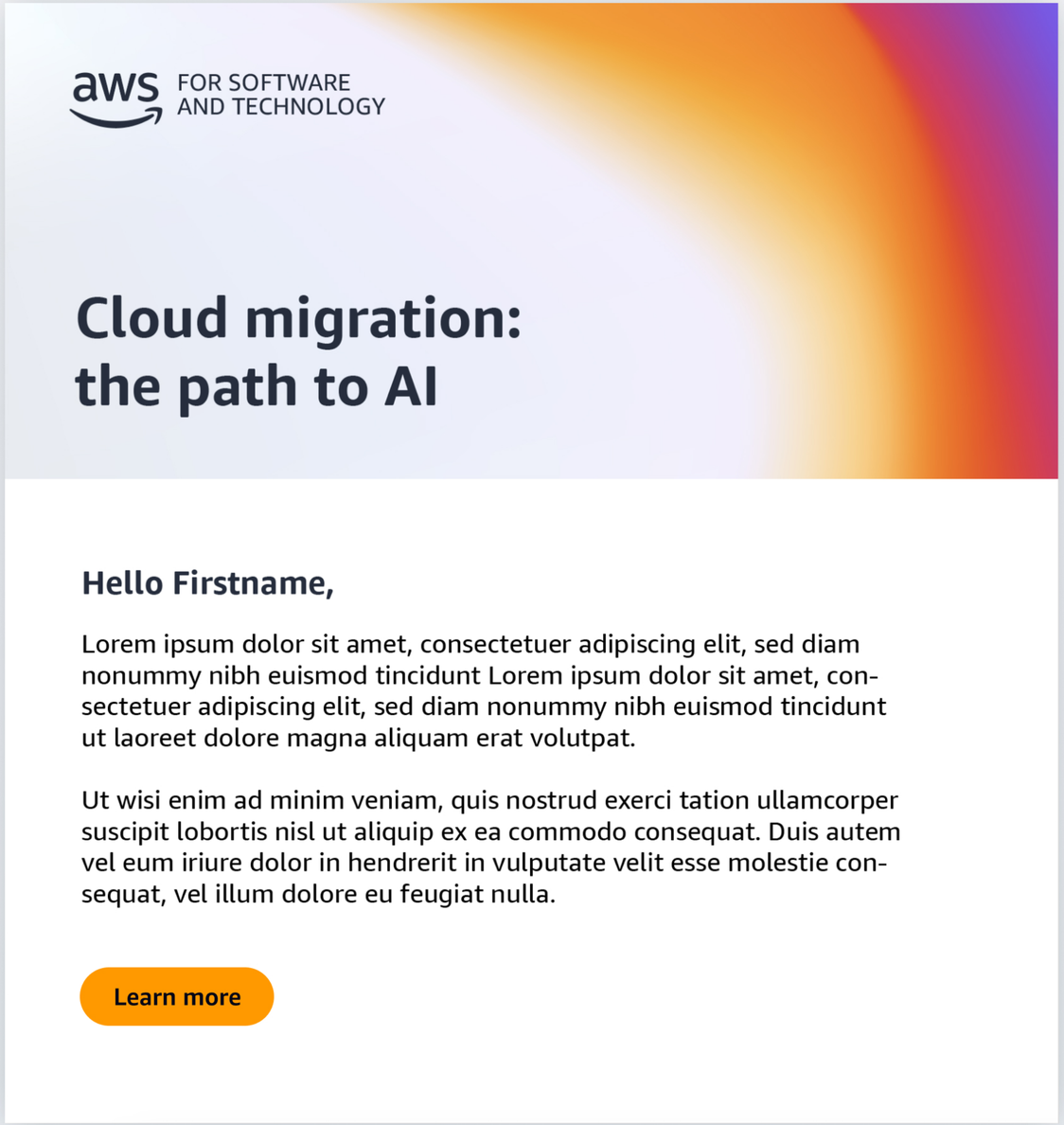
rket
for R&D and
testing new apps, and gain access to AWS's RethinkDB, a more agile platform for building scalable, real-time apps.

Improve security
Take advantage of greater control and security capabilities, with over 230 security, compliance and governance services and features offered by AWS.

Generate new revenue streams
Accelerate your move to new cloud based delivery models with AWS SaaS Factory program and discover new ways to grow your business.

Expand global footprint
Quickly scale resources and apps to reach new markets through AWS's global footprint of services.

9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Cloud migration: the path to AI
Hello Firstname,
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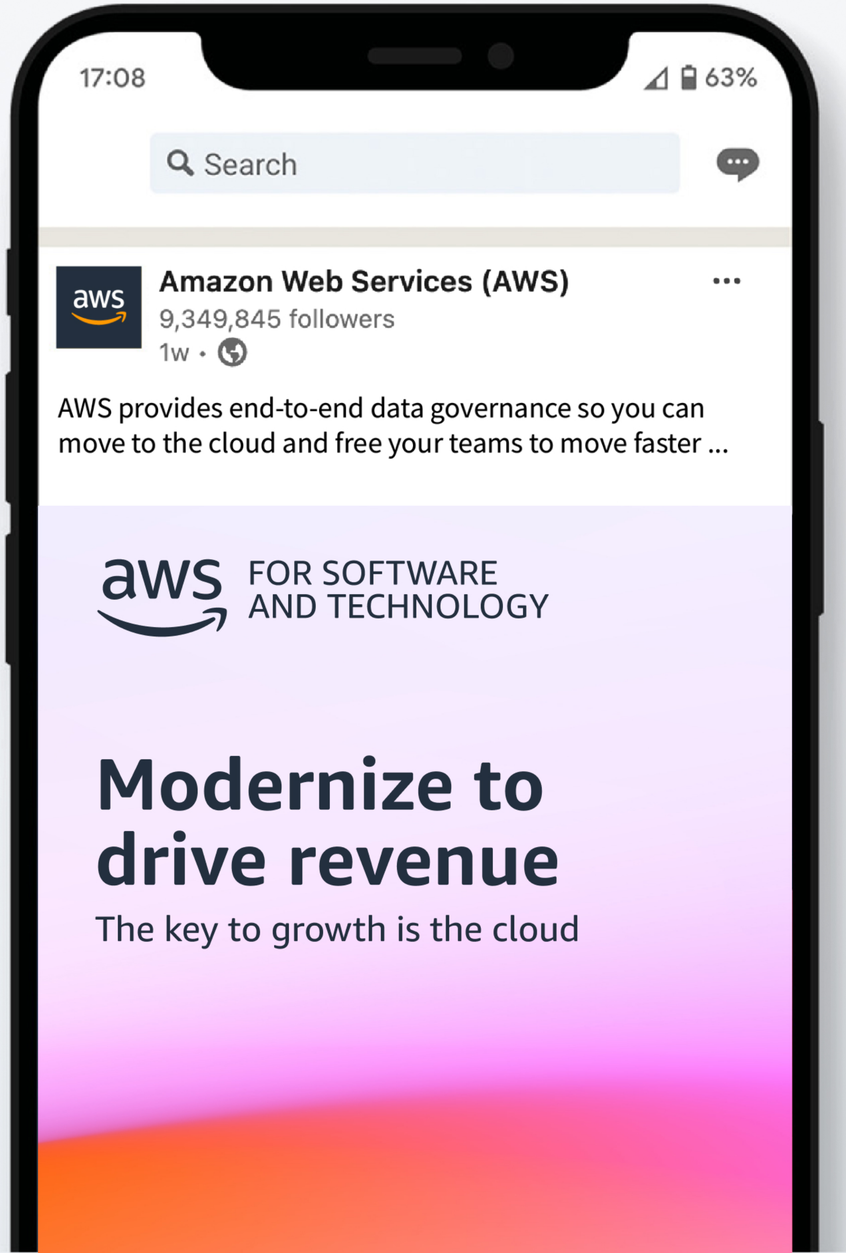
Learn more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9,349,845 followers
1w •
AWS provides end-to-end data governance so you can move to the cloud and free your teams to move faster ...
aws
FOR SOFTWARE AND TECHNOLOGY
Modernize to drive revenue
The key to growth is the cloud

Event fixture

SECTION 04

Toolkit

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Toolkit

Starter Set

To get you started, we've curated a selection of assets for immediate use. These assets were created with your unique, ISV-specific needs in mind, using templates and guidance.

You can locate the kit of parts on Highspot.

Available templates and files	Format
AWS for Software and Technology Logos	SVG and PNG
Presentation Starter Template	PowerPoint
Photography and Campaign Images	JPEG
Marketing Illustrations	AI, SVG and PNG
Backgrounds	AI, JPG

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